

Keeping In LINE— Minot Officials Agree Three-Man System Best

By EUGENE FITZGERALD

Three Minot basketball officials certainly not strangers to North Dakotans who watch high school basketball, expressed their opinions on officiating, as a group and individually, in a lengthy article done for the Minot Daily News by Minot School of the Major City publication.



Fitzgerald

The Minot officials, Bernard Busse, Reuben (Oscar) Hammond and Herb Parker, are advocates of the three-man system. It was Busse, who has retired because his shirt wore out, who conceived the idea in Dickinson about 15 years ago.

Parker claims it is the best method for both teams and the officials.

The Minot officials offered convincing arguments for the three-man system. There may be some reluctance to accept the three-man system, because it increases officiating costs by one-third.

There was reluctance to accept the two-man system, and newcomers hardly believe it when it is explained that Dick Huler, the Moorhead veteran, once handled such an important series as the NDAC-NDU set, with the jump ball, alone.

He was aided only by the partisan crowds, usually with bad advice.

The danger of confusion resulting in numerous double fouls is virtually eliminated, Parker says. "We have worked together so much and our interpretation of situations is so much the same that a double foul is rarely ever called."

"You aren't always chasing the play, you're waiting for it," Busse said, adding that "somebody is always ahead of the ball and 'you always have a good look at the ball'."

"You can't see them all in fast action," Parker says in defending an overlooked foul.

"I have called fouls for incident, contact which I knew I should not have called," Hammond explained.

Busse said he blundered last season when he blew his whistle too quickly, certain a foul was going to result. "Contact never took place," he said, even though the foul was called for that reason.

Hammond and Parker agree that the toughest call for an official is whether blocking or charging is the infraction.

Busse says traveling is the most difficult problem.

"If the defense player gives the dribbler enough room to devote the burden is with the dribbler," Hammond says.

"If the defending player at any time gets his body in front of the dribbler, facing him with both feet on the floor, the man with the ball is responsible," Parker says.

Parker would like to see the rule which he says is inclined to favor the offense, changed to be more helpful to the defense.

Busse feels it is difficult for an official on top of a play to watch for extra steps and a shooting infraction at the same time.

Parker feels that an area of frustrating weakness perhaps comes in allowing traveling, permitting the little fellow to maneuver excessively with his feet, if he doesn't gain an advantage.

The big man on the post has had his foot movement curtailed in recent years, Parker said.

On contact, the Minot trio was in agreement. "If it doesn't affect the play, overlook it."

Busse and Hammond are inclined to the belief that the five-foul elimination rule is "kinda rough."

On the five-foul rule Parker with the Colts he was released. "If a player were permitted to re-enter after a fifth foul in Canadian football."

It would tend to decrease the participation of others. If athletes is valuable to a group, then the more taking part the better."

The trio is in agreement on a 24-second rule and awarding the ball out-of-bounds on an offensive foul. Parker believes teams may be handicapped at the start because of the 24-second rule, but eventually it would not be a hardship.

Hammond says the 24-second rule would eliminate the excessive free-throwing and make a better game for the spectator in the late stages.

The Minot trio handled the East-West football playoff between St. Mary's of Bismarck and Grand Forks. They are in agreement that basketball officiating is more strenuous and presents more problems.

Other highlights of their objections or approval include more different types of judgment calls in basketball, less time to enforce a basketball call, a different type of decision-making in independent basketball than in college or high school play, familiarity of spectators who are closer to the action and rules changes annually in basketball.

Andy Cohen is returning to baseball.

Fans of the former manager of the Eau Claire team of the Northern League will be glad to learn that Andy not only is returning to baseball, but that he will be in the majors.

Cohen, selected as manager of the Northern League All-Star team, an indication of his popularity, will coach infielders for the Philadelphia Phillies and coach at first base.

At Philadelphia, Cohen will join Ken Silvestri, former manager of the Fargo-Moorhead Twins, bullpen coach for the Phillies.

Cohen, who played second base for the New York Giants under John McGraw, never made it to the majors otherwise. He made it as a pilot to Class AAA and was in the discussion as a possibility for major league managing jobs.

Cohen was given a bad deal at Denver after the 1958 season when the Yankees withdrew their affiliation and was out of baseball last season, apparently for good.

Cohen, a Baltimore native, played basketball, football and baseball at Alabama. He was featured on the Fargo Eagles Baseball team in 1958, where he was a hit.

Denver Names Grid Coach

DENVER (AP) — Frank Filchock, former quarterback for the Washington Redskins and New York Giants of the National Football League, club president Bob Hoosman, announced Saturday.

Filchock, 43, has been coaching in Canadian professional football for several years, serving at Edmonton, Regina, Saskatchewan, Calgary. He played at Hamilton and Montreal before taking up coaching. In college he played for the University of Indiana.

Filchock was associated at Regina with Dean Giffing, Denver's new general manager.

Best Bell, the late commissioner of the National Football League, suspended Filchock and Merle Hapes of the New York Giants in 1947 for actions detrimental to the welfare of the NFL and pro football. They were accused of failing to report a ship game between the Giants and Chicago Bears.

Neither player accepted a bribe. Bell later lifted Filchock's suspension.

The Giants dropped Filchock and he signed with the Baltimore Colts. After playing one game, he was released. Since the 1947 season he has been in Canadian football.